

The **evidence** room

You already know the forms. This lesson is about reaching for them before your brain reaches for the shortcut.

THE REFLEX

~~It's possible that he missed the flight.~~

THE TARGET

He might have missed the flight.

01

Why the shortcut sounds flat

Both sentences above are correct. They are not equal.

Probably and **it's possible that** push the uncertainty outside the verb. You end up commenting on the situation, like a reporter reading a bulletin.

A modal carries the uncertainty inside the verb itself. One word does the work, and the speaker is inside the moment rather than describing it from a distance. That compression is a large part of what makes a master speaker sound like one.

REAL TALK

Em português a incerteza mora fora do verbo: "provavelmente ele perdeu o voo". Em inglês ela mora dentro. Por isso "probably" sai tão fácil na sua boca: é a tradução direta do seu instinto. O modal não é mais bonito, é mais econômico, e o ouvido nativo espera essa economia.

The certainty ladder

Cada linha é um grau de certeza. A coluna muda com o tempo verbal: se a situação é agora, modal + verbo. Se já aconteceu, modal + have + particípio. O verbo pode ser qualquer um, e quando a ação está em curso vem be + ing.

95%	NOW must + verbo He must know about it already. He must be working from home today. Must aqui não é obrigação, é a certeza que vem da evidência. Qualquer verbo entra depois do modal, não só be.	PAST must have + particípio He must have left already.
80%	NOW should + verbo She should know the answer. She should be arriving any minute. O que era esperado, com base no que é normal.	PAST should have + particípio She should have arrived an hour ago.
50%	NOW might / may / could + verbo They might live in the same building. They might be waiting outside. É aqui que probably mora. Probably vale uns 70%, então traduz para might, may ou could, nunca para must.	PAST might / may / could have + particípio They might have got the wrong address.
30%	NOW might not / may not + verbo She might not want to talk about it. She might not be working today. Ainda em aberto, só que pendendo para o não. Não confunda com can't have.	PAST might not / may not have + particípio She might not have seen the message.
05%	NOW can't + verbo He can't mean that. They can't be working at this hour. O espelho negativo de must. É o que quase nunca sai na fala, e o que mais impressiona quando sai.	PAST can't have + particípio He can't have finished it in ten minutes.

Eight rooms, eight deductions

Leia as pistas e reescreva as duas frases usando um modal. A expressão em cinza marca o grau de certeza, e o modal precisa carregar o mesmo peso.

01 The empty desk, 9:40 am

- A coat is still on the back of the chair.
- The laptop is open, screen unlocked.
- The coffee is warm and half finished.

NOW

It's obvious that he is somewhere in the building.

PAST

It was not possible for him to go home like this.

02 Flat 4B, third day

- Post is piling up in front of the door.
- Every curtain has been closed since Monday.
- The car has not moved from the space.

NOW

It's impossible that anyone is inside.

PAST

It's extremely likely that they travelled last weekend.

03 Read at 02:14

- Your message was opened at two in the morning.
- The typing indicator appeared twice.
- No reply came.

NOW

It's possible that she is still deciding what to say.

PAST

Maybe she started writing and then gave up.

04 Dinner, and she orders water

- She always orders wine on a Friday.
- Her eyes are red and her phone is face down.
- She changes the subject twice.

NOW

I'm almost certain that something is wrong.

PAST

It's quite possible that she got bad news today.

05 Meeting room 2, after lunch

- The whiteboard has been wiped completely clean.
- A box of personal files is sitting by the door.
- An HR badge was left on the table.

NOW

I'm sure that somebody is leaving the company.

PAST

It wasn't possible for them to plan this weeks ago in secret.

06 The bill

- His card is declined twice.
- He laughs and says the machine is broken.
- He pays in cash from an envelope.

NOW

It's possible that he doesn't want to explain it at the table.

PAST

It's possible that the card expired last month.

07 Keys in the fridge

- The car keys are on the top shelf, next to the eggs.
- The milk is on the counter, warm.
- The front door was left unlocked all night.

NOW

It's obvious that you are exhausted.

PAST

It's not possible that you slept more than four hours.

08 Twelve minutes

- The interview ended in twelve minutes.
- Nobody asked about salary or notice period.
- They walked you to the door themselves.

NOW

It's not very probable that they will call you back.

PAST

It's impossible that they were serious about the role.

Rewrite the reflex

Mesmo sentido, versão com modal. Mais de uma resposta funciona na maioria delas.

01 It's obvious that he forgot.

02 It's possible that she's still at work.

03 It's possible that they didn't get the email.

04 It's impossible that he said that.

05 I'm sure they left already.

06 Maybe I'll call you later.

07 It's possible that the flight was cancelled.

08 He's probably stuck in traffic.

09 It's not possible that she knew.

10 Maybe she's going to say no.

11 It's possible that I misunderstood.

12 I'm sure you're tired.

The banned round

Dez minutos de fala com duas palavras removidas do seu vocabulário.

Banidos: probably, it's possible that, maybe, I think that.

Obrigatório: toda resposta abre com um modal.

Regra do escorregão: quando escapar uma palavra banida, o professor marca e você repete a frase.

O objetivo: não é zero escorregões. É se pegar antes do professor.

Your neighbour has not taken the bins out for two weeks. What happened?

A colleague left the company on a Friday with no goodbye email.

Someone opened your message and started typing three times.

Your flight is delayed and nobody at the gate is announcing anything.

A restaurant that was always full is empty on a Saturday night.

Your friend cancelled dinner twice this month with the same excuse.

A parcel says delivered but there is nothing at your door.

Your manager booked a meeting for tomorrow with no agenda.

The evidence room

Respostas modelo. Outras formulações valem, desde que o grau de certeza seja o mesmo.

NOTAS DO PROFESSOR

O objetivo desta aula não é ensinar forma, é criar atrito no atalho. Três regras de condução:

1. Não explique nada durante a fala dele. Diga só "modal" e espere a reformulação. A correção precisa ser barata e rápida, senão vira aula de gramática de novo.
2. Se ele acertar o modal mas errar o tempo, aponte só a evidência: "isso já aconteceu?". Ele mesmo corrige.
3. Se ele travar entre must e might, pergunte "quantas explicações existem?". Uma explicação leva a must, várias levam a might.

Retomada na aula seguinte: abra com três cenas novas nos primeiros cinco minutos, sem aviso e sem revisão. O ganho está na recuperação espaçada, não no volume.

01	The empty desk, 9:40 am	NOW He must be somewhere in the building. PAST He can't have gone home like this.
02	Flat 4B, third day	NOW There can't be anyone inside. PAST They must have travelled last weekend.
03	Read at 02:14	NOW She may still be deciding what to say. PAST She might have started writing and then given up.
04	Dinner, and she orders water	NOW Something must be wrong. PAST She might have got bad news today.
05	Meeting room 2, after lunch	NOW Somebody must be leaving the company. PAST They can't have planned this weeks ago in secret.
06	The bill	NOW He may not want to explain it at the table. PAST The card could have expired last month.
07	Keys in the fridge	NOW You must be exhausted. PAST You can't have slept more than four hours.
08	Twelve minutes	NOW They might not call you back. PAST They can't have been serious about the role.

Rewrite the reflex

- 01 **He must have forgotten.**
Uma explicação só, então must. Se a frase dissesse probably, o alvo seria might.
- 02 **She might still be at work.**
Também vale: may still be, could still be.
- 03 **They may not have got the email.**
Porta ainda aberta. Não é can't have.

04 He can't have said that.

Também vale: he couldn't have said that.

05 They must have left already.

Must have é a certeza que você deduziu, não a que te contaram.

06 I might call you later.

Palpite sobre o futuro. Sem have aqui.

07 The flight could have been cancelled.

Passiva no passado: modal + have been + particípio.

08 He might be stuck in traffic.

Probably vale uns 70%. Para chegar em must, a frase teria que dizer que não existe outra explicação.

09 She can't have known.

O espelho negativo de must have known.

10 She might say no.

Modal simples para um palpite sobre o futuro.

11 I may have misunderstood.

Frase de reunião. Vale automatizar essa primeiro.

12 You must be tired.

O estado é agora, então sem have.

The banned round

01 Your neighbour has not taken the bins out for two weeks. What happened?

They must have gone away.
They can't have been at home since the start of the month.

02 A colleague left the company on a Friday with no goodbye email.

He must have been let go.
He may not have been allowed to say anything.

03 Someone opened your message and started typing three times.

She might have changed her mind twice.
She can't have known what to answer.

04 Your flight is delayed and nobody at the gate is announcing anything.

There must be a problem they haven't confirmed yet.
The crew might not have arrived.

05 A restaurant that was always full is empty on a Saturday night.

The chef could have left.
They must have lost their best reviews.

06 Your friend cancelled dinner twice this month with the same excuse.

Something must be going on at home.
She might not want to tell you the real reason.

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- 07 A parcel says delivered but there is nothing at your door.** The driver must have left it with a neighbour.
It can't have been delivered to this address.
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- 08 Your manager booked a meeting for tomorrow with no agenda.** It might be about the budget.
It can't be good news, or she would have said so.
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